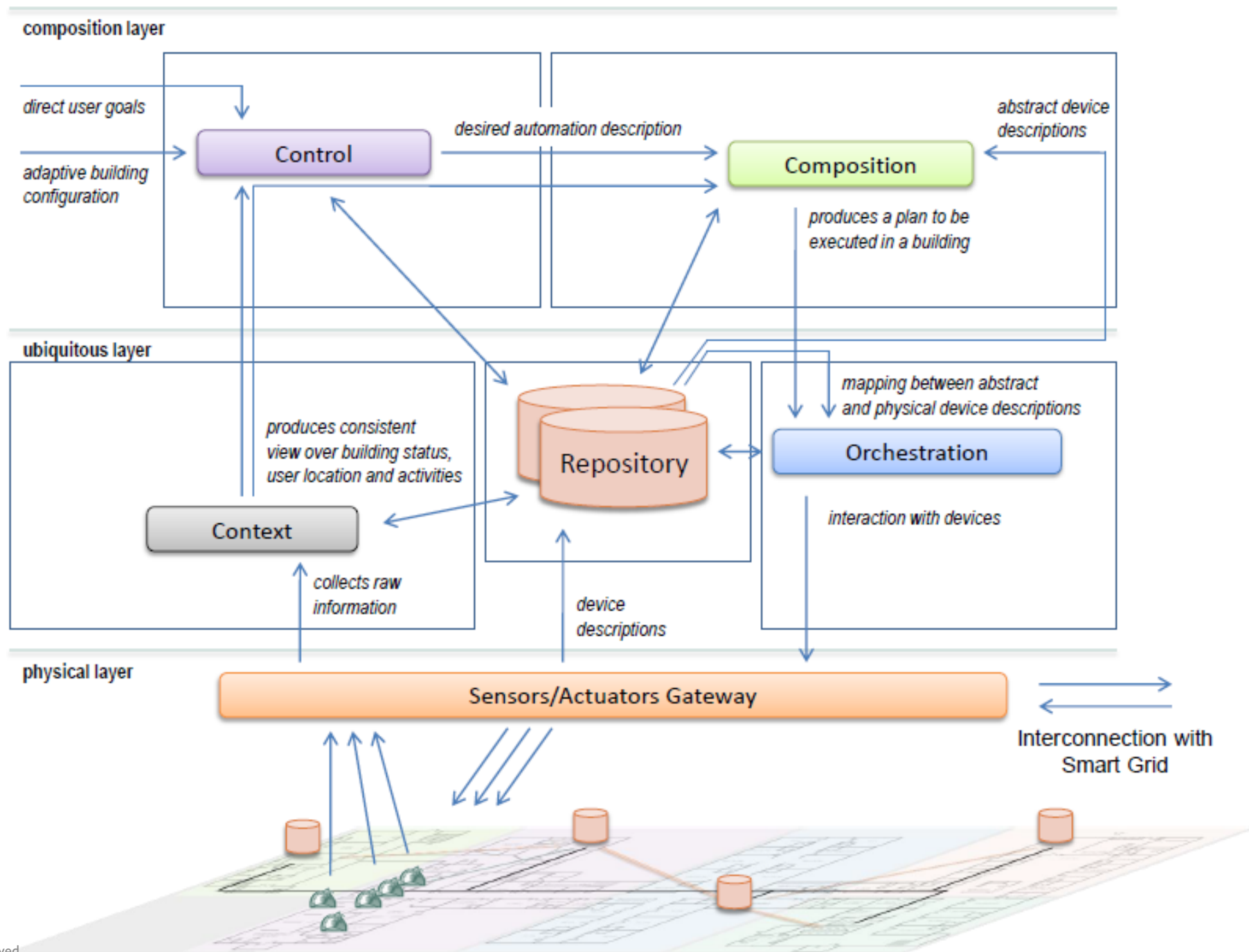


University of Stuttgart  
Germany

# Context

Design choices, trilateration, and activity recognition

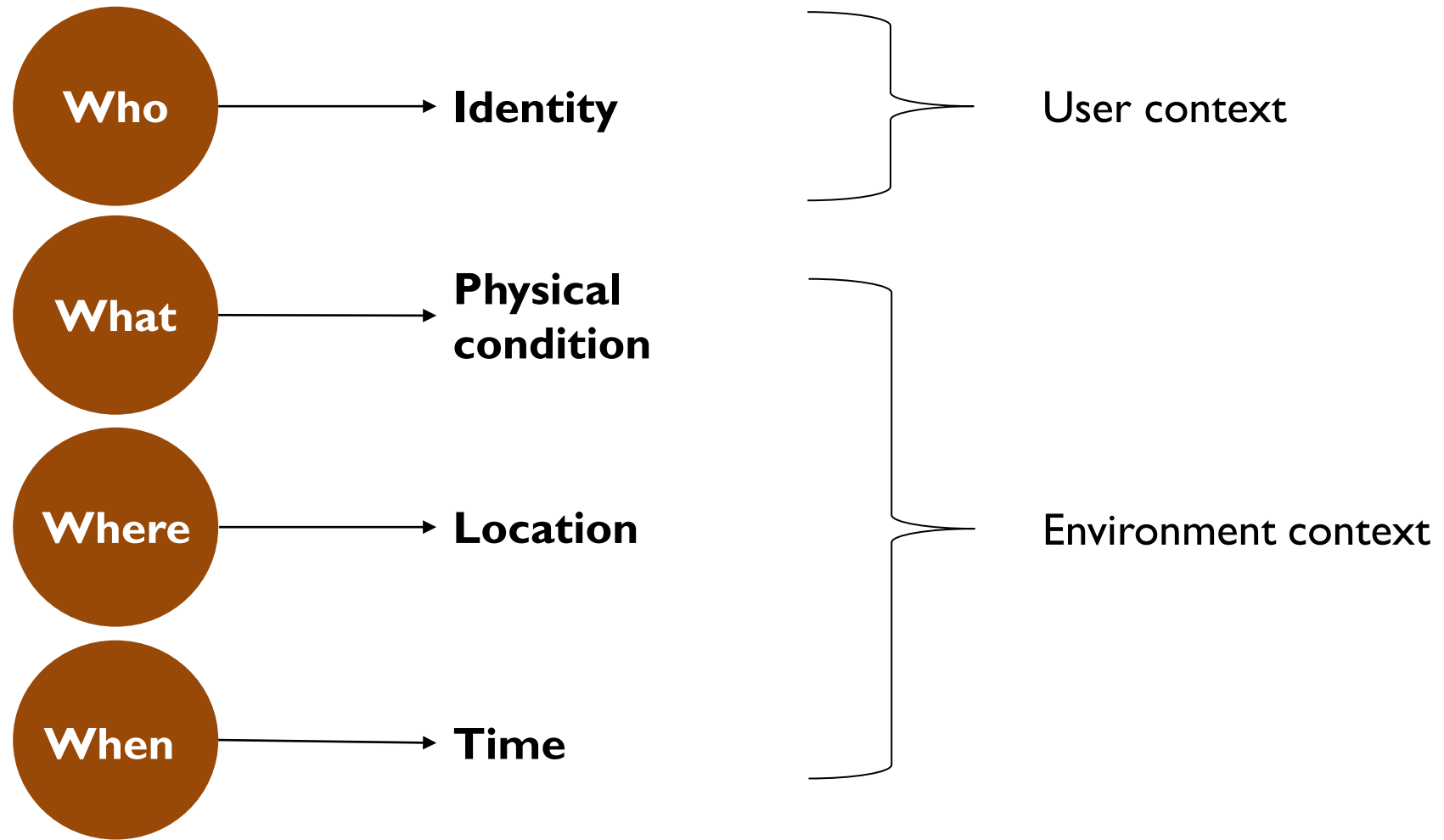
Ilche Georgievski



# Context via feature space

- Context related to human factors
  - Information about a person
    - Daily behavioural patterns
    - Emotional state (e.g., angry, calm)
    - Physiological state (e.g., heart rate)
  - Person's social environment
    - Co-location of others
    - Social interaction
    - Group dynamics
  - Person's activities
    - Spontaneous activity
    - Engaged activities
- Context related to physical environment
  - Location
    - Absolute position
    - Relative position
    - Co-location
  - Physical conditions
    - Temperature
    - Air quality

# Context via dimensions



# Relevance of entities

An entity that is considered *relevant to the interaction* between a user and the system

# Example

- Consider a smart system to assist museum visitors
- Context could be *a museum visitor is interested in an exhibition item*
- Relevant entities are relative position and native language of museum visitors
- Other entities, such as body temperature, are not relevant

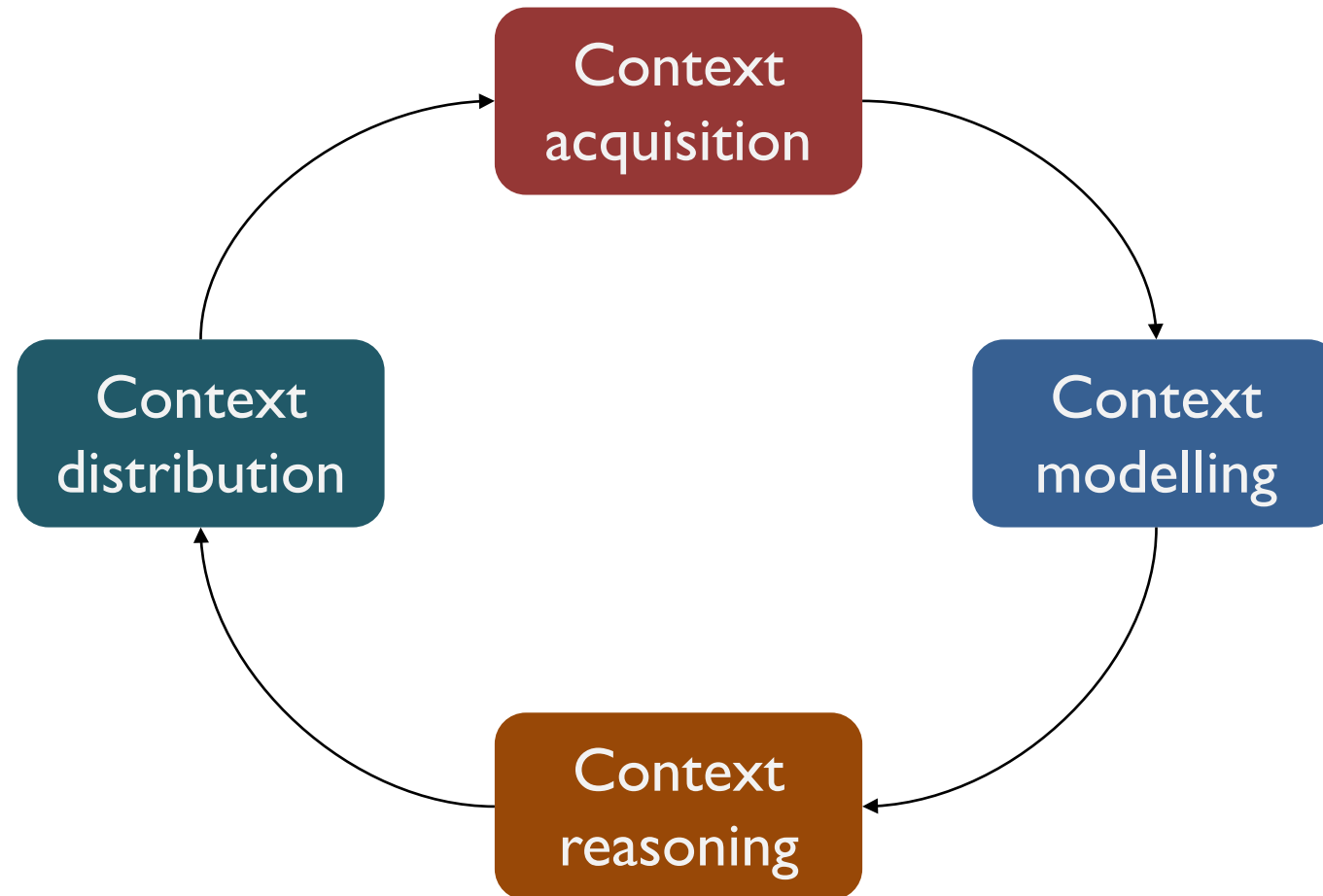
# Context awareness

- A system is *context aware* if it uses context to provide relevant information and services to people
- A context-aware system adapts its operation based on context relevant to the environment or people

Where and how to integrate context in a system?



# Life cycle of context



# Context acquisition

- Environment context
  - Electronic-based IoT
  - Software-based IoT
  - Human-based IoT
  - Virtual IoT
- User context
  - Same types of IoT as for environment context
  - Direct interaction

# Examples

| Context            | Relevant data sources                                    |
|--------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| Temperature        | Temperature sensor                                       |
| Ambient sound      | Microphones                                              |
| Orientation        | Compass, magnetic field sensor                           |
| Air quality        | CO <sub>2</sub> sensor                                   |
| Energy consumption | Smart meter                                              |
| Location outdoors  | GPS                                                      |
| Location indoors   | RFID, Wi-Fi probes, beacons                              |
| Identity           | Email, RFID                                              |
| Activity           | Accelerometers, PIR motion sensor, pressure sensor, etc. |

# Design and implementation considerations

- Communication
- Configuration
  - Sensor calibration
  - Frequency
  - ...
- Data processing
  - Filtering
  - Aggregation
  - ...

# Context modelling

- Context information definition and organisation
- Context validation and storage

# Modelling techniques

- Key-value pairs
  - Data structure: simple and flat
  - Access: linear search
  - Pros: easy to manage and parse
  - Cons: exact matches, inexpressive structure, weak formalism
- Mark-up schemes
  - Data structure: hierarchical (e.g., XML)
  - Access: mark-up query language
  - Pros: distributed model, W3C standards
  - Cons: weak formalism
- Graphical modelling
  - Data structure: graph (e.g., UML)
  - Access: transformation algorithm
  - Pros: more expressive than key-value and mark-up schemes
  - Cons: lack of formalism for online automated access

# Modelling techniques

- Object-oriented modelling
  - Data structure: programming objects
  - Access: accessor methods
  - Pros: distributed OO is mature, reusability
  - Cons: handling incompleteness
- Logic-based modelling
  - Data structure: logical conditions
  - Access: logical reasoning
  - Pros: strong formalism, expressive structuring
  - Cons: handling uncertainty, heterogeneity and temporal aspects; high complexity
- Ontology-based modelling
  - Data structure: concepts and axioms (logic, rules)
  - Access: ontological reasoning
  - Pros: expressive structuring, managing heterogeneity
  - Cons: handling uncertainty, scalability issues

# Context reasoning

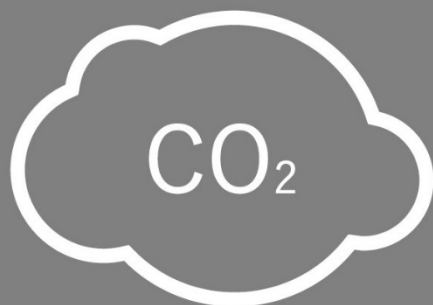
- Context creation
  - Context generated by processing raw sensor data
    - Scaling
    - Transforming
    - Fusion
    - ...
  - Context generated by reasoning over raw sensor data
    - Inference
    - Abstraction
  - Context derived from other contexts
    - Combination or fusion



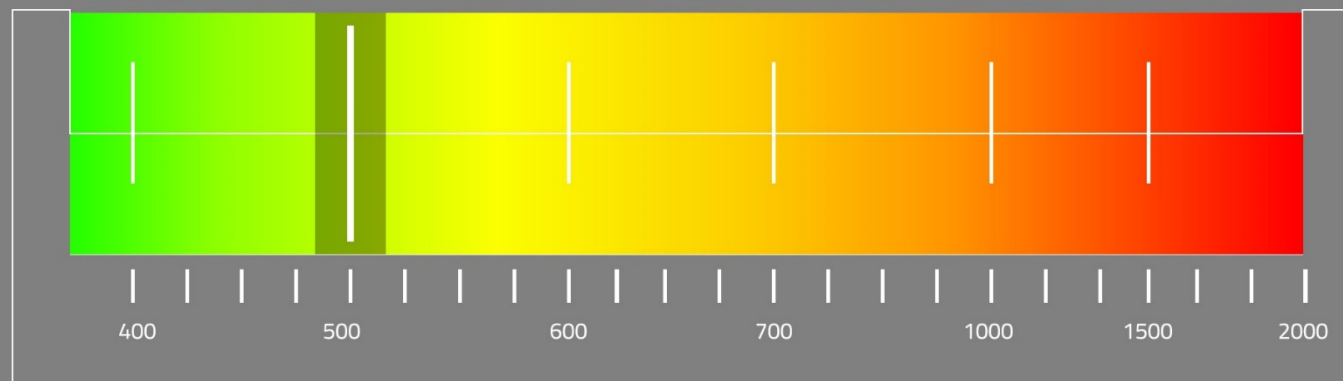
**LIVE**

Duurzaamheidskamer - Gedempte Zuiderdiep, 98  
WEDNESDAY / 3 MAY / 2017

09:37:46



**500**ppm  
AIR  
QUALITY

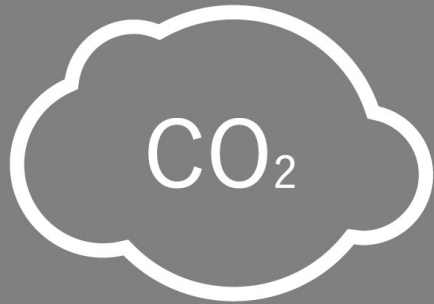


*Make buildings smart and energy sustainable.*

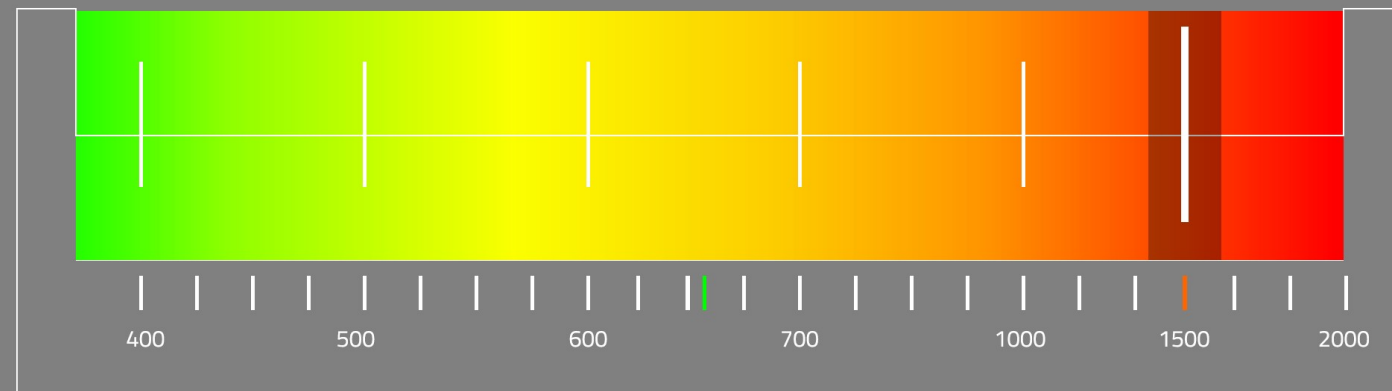
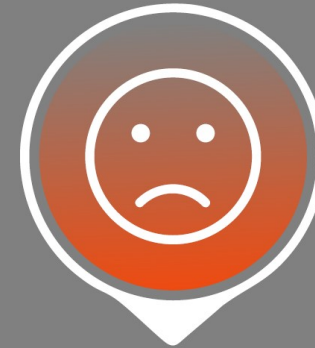
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WEDNESDAY / 3 MAY / 2017

09:37:46



1500 ppm  
AIR  
QUALITY



*Make buildings smart and energy sustainable.*



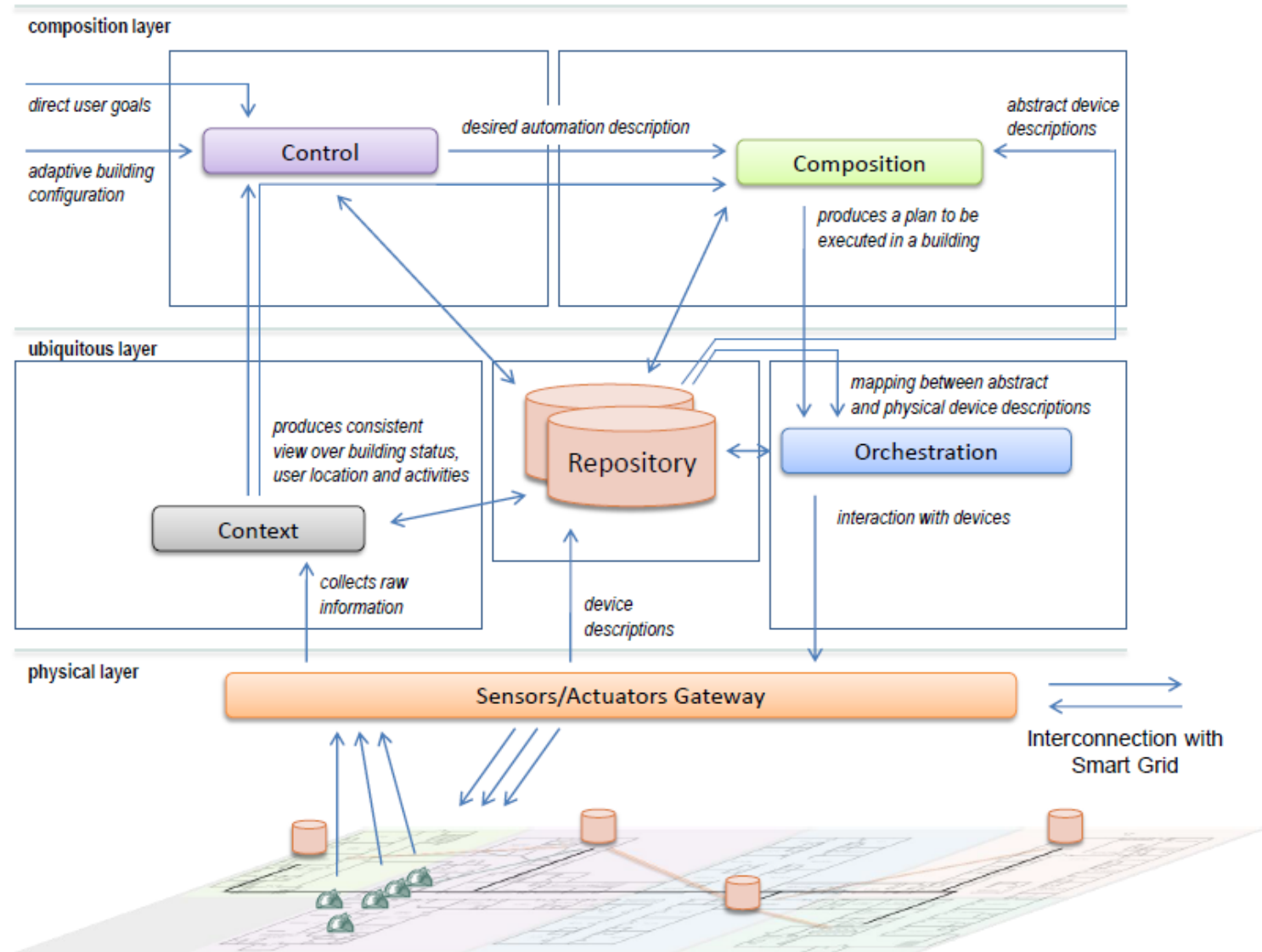
# Reasoning techniques

- Supervised learning
- Unsupervised learning
- Rule-based engines
- Fuzzy logic
- Ontological reasoning
- Probabilistic reasoning

# Context distribution

- Request-reply communication
- Indirect communication

# Adapt to context



# Exercises

- Describe why context is relevant for smart systems, and detail two scenarios where smart systems can be used within an elderly care environment.
- Consider the need for a smart system to adapt to context automatically. Give an example of an application in which the high speed at which such a system can adapt is good and another example in which high speed is not good.
- What aspects are important to consider when designing and implementing a context component for smart systems?
- Give three examples of context-aware behaviour of a smart system for controlling the heating system of a hospital.

**TRILATERATION**

# Problem

Given a representation of physical space, a set of sensor readings, and an object of interest, assign a location to the object in the representation of physical space which best represents its actual physical presence.



# Localisation techniques

- Range-based localisation
  - Triangulation
  - Trilateration
- Ranging techniques for trilateration
  - Received Signal Strength Indicator (RSSI)
  - Time of Arrival (ToA)

# Trilateration (I)

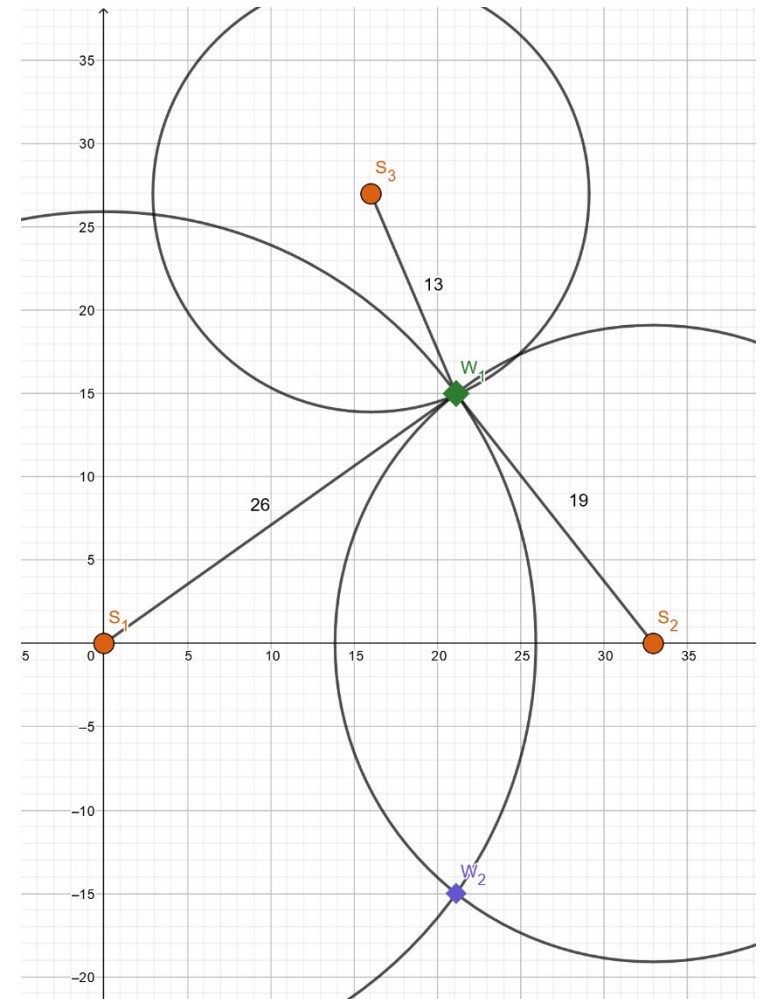
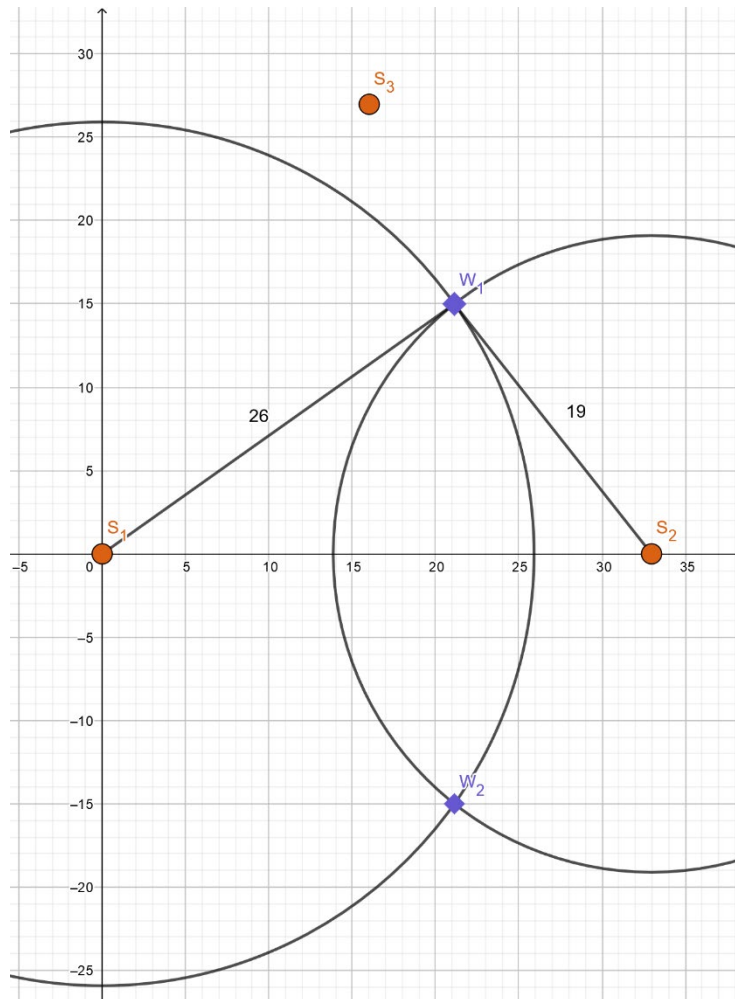
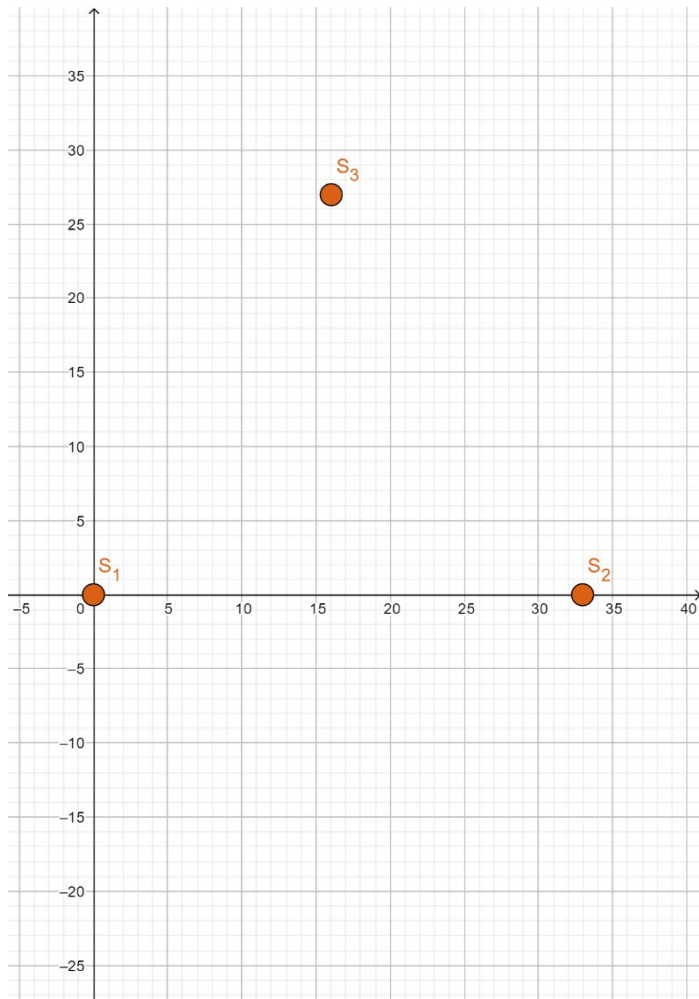
- Localisation based on measured distances between a node and several anchor points with known locations
- Basic concept
  - Given the distance of an anchor, it is known that the node must be along the circumference of a circle centered at anchor and a radius equal to the node-anchor distance
- Needed anchors
  - Two-dimensional space: at least three non-collinear anchors
  - Three-dimensional space: at least four non-coplanar anchors

# Trilateration (2)

- Given
  - $(x_i, y_i)$ , which are coordinates of an anchor point  $i$
  - $r_i$ , which is a distance between anchor point  $i$  and a node  $u$
- Needed
  - $(x_u, y_u)$ , which are coordinates of a node  $u$
- Solution
  - Graphical approach
  - Matrix equation
  - System of equations

# Exercise

Consider three GPS satellites,  $S_1$ ,  $S_2$ , and  $S_3$ , and one smartwatch  $W$ . Suppose that, in a rectangular coordinate system, the locations of the satellites  $S_1$ ,  $S_2$ , and  $S_3$  are  $(0,0)$ ,  $(33,0)$ , and  $(16,27)$ , respectively. Note that 1 unit represents 1 km. The distances between  $W$  and  $S_1$ ,  $S_2$ , and  $S_3$  are 26 km, 19 km, and 13 km, respectively. Assume that  $S_1$ ,  $S_2$ ,  $S_3$  and  $W$  lie on the same horizontal plane (two-dimensional space). Find the location of the smartwatch  $W$  using trilateration.



# Matrix equation

$$2 \begin{bmatrix} x_3 - x_1 & y_3 - y_1 \\ x_3 - x_2 & y_3 - y_2 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} x_u \\ y_u \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} (r_1^2 - r_3^2) - (x_1^2 - x_3^2) - (y_1^2 - y_3^2) \\ (r_2^2 - r_3^2) - (x_2^2 - x_3^2) - (y_2^2 - y_3^2) \end{bmatrix}$$

$$(x_1, y_1) = (0, 0)$$

$$(x_2, y_2) = (33, 0)$$

$$(x_3, y_3) = (16, 27)$$

$$2 \begin{bmatrix} 16 & 27 \\ -17 & 27 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} x_u \\ y_u \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 1492 \\ 88 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$r_1 = 26$$

$$r_2 = 19$$

$$r_3 = 13$$

$$\begin{cases} 32x_u + 54y_u = 1492 \\ -34x_u + 54y_u = 88 \end{cases}$$

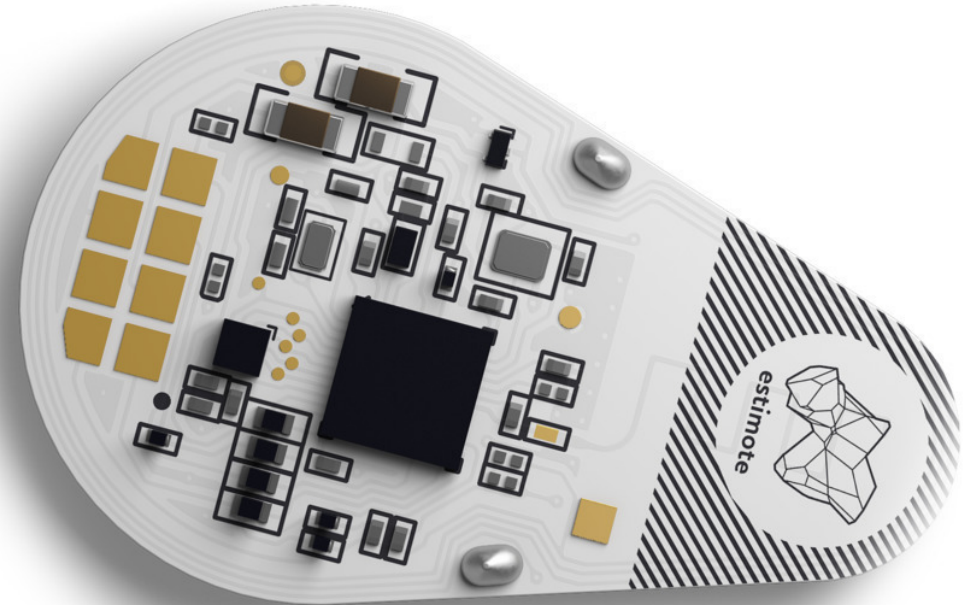
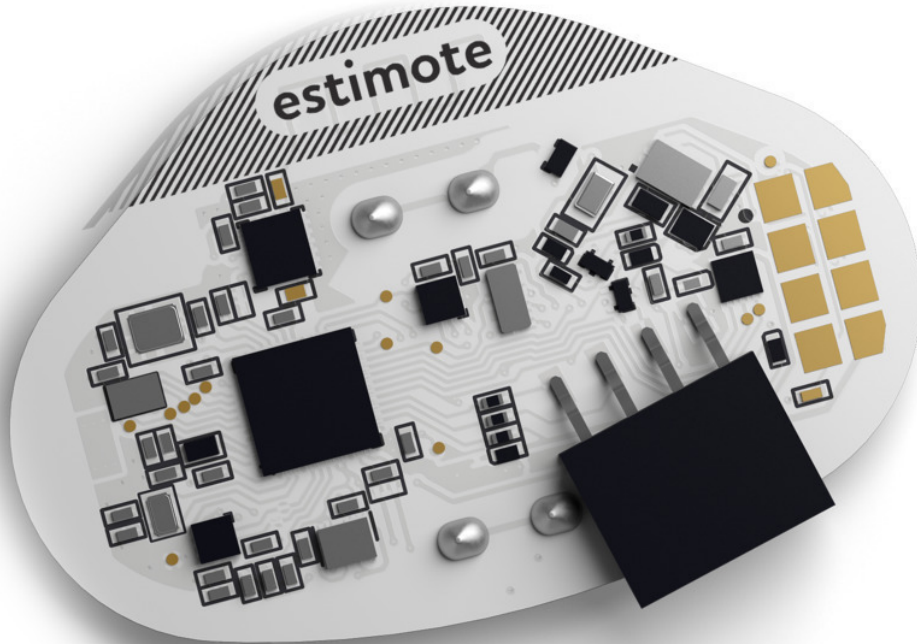
$$\begin{cases} x_u \cong 21 \\ y_u \cong 15 \end{cases}$$

# Exercise

Consider three GPS satellites,  $S_1$ ,  $S_2$ , and  $S_3$ , and one smartwatch  $W$ . Suppose that, in a rectangular coordinate system, the locations of the satellites  $S_1$ ,  $S_2$ , and  $S_3$  are  $(0,0)$ ,  $(21,0)$ , and  $(9,15)$ , respectively. Note that 1 unit represents 1 km. The distances between  $W$  and  $S_1$ ,  $S_2$ , and  $S_3$  are 13 km, 20 km, and 5 km, respectively. Assume that  $S_1$ ,  $S_2$ ,  $S_3$  and  $W$  lie on the same horizontal plane (two-dimensional space). Find the location of the smartwatch  $W$  using trilateration. Does  $W$  lie within or outside  $\Delta S_1 S_2 S_3$ ?



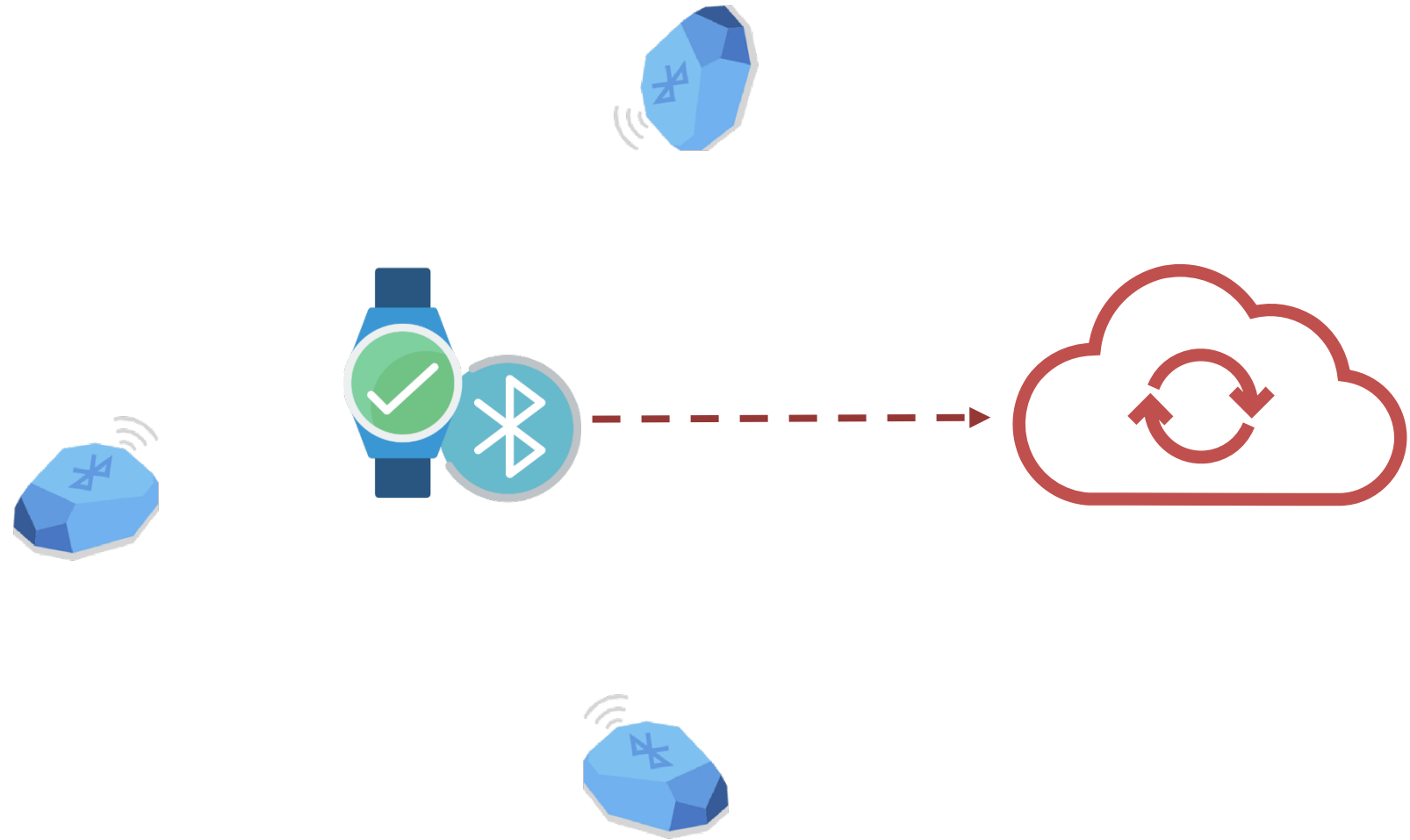
# Beacons







# Indoor location using beacons



# Estimote Proximity Beacons

- Default settings
  - [Broadcasting](#) Power: -4 dBm
  - [RSSI](#): [-26,-100] at maximum broadcasting power
  - [Measured](#) Power: -66
- Advertising packet [types](#)
  - Estimote Location
  - Estimote Telemetry

# Algorithm

- Scan for Estimote Proximity beacons
- Upon a beacon's detection, calculate a distance estimation
- When three beacons have been detected and their distances are known, calculate approximate position using trilateration

# Python library

- `beacontools`
  - Parsing and scanning library
  - Supports Eddystone, iBeacon and Estimote beacons
  - For Estimote beacons, it supports only advertising packets of type Estimote Telemetry

# Beacons storage

```
beacons = {  
  "beacon_1": {  
    "x": 0,  
    "y": 0,  
    "r": 0  
  },  
  "beacon_2": {  
    "x": 7,  
    "y": 3,  
    "r": 0  
  },  
  "beacon_3": {  
    "x": 4,  
    "y": 8,  
    "r": 0  
  }  
}
```

# Scanning

```
import time
from beacontools import BeaconScanner

def callback(bt_addr, rssi, packet, additional_info):
    print("<%s, %d> %s %s" % (bt_addr, rssi, packet, additional_info))
    # needs to be revised to account for distance estimation of all three beacons and
    # for position estimation once distances of all three beacons are known

# scan for any packet
scanner = BeaconScanner(callback)
scanner.start()

time.sleep(30)
scanner.stop()
```

# Distance estimation

$$d = \sqrt[\alpha]{\frac{cP_{tx}}{P_{recv}}}$$

- Assume

- $P_{tx} = -66$

- $c = 2$

- $\alpha = 2$

$$d = \sqrt{\frac{2P_{tx}}{P_{recv}}}$$

**Table 3.6 Path loss exponent and standard deviation measured in different buildings [And94]**

| Building               | Frequency (MHz) | n   | $\sigma$ (dB) |
|------------------------|-----------------|-----|---------------|
| Retail Stores          | 914             | 2.2 | 8.7           |
| Grocery Store          | 914             | 1.8 | 5.2           |
| Office, hard partition | 1500            | 3.0 | 7.0           |
| Office, soft partition | 900             | 2.4 | 9.6           |
| Office, soft partition | 1900            | 2.6 | 14.1          |
| Factory LOS            |                 |     |               |
| Textile/Chemical       | 1300            | 2.0 | 3.0           |
| Textile/Chemical       | 4000            | 2.1 | 7.0           |
| Paper/Cereals          | 1300            | 1.8 | 6.0           |
| Metalworking           | 1300            | 1.6 | 5.8           |
| Suburban Home          |                 |     |               |
| Indoor Street          | 900             | 3.0 | 7.0           |
| Factory OBS            |                 |     |               |
| Textile/Chemical       | 4000            | 2.1 | 9.7           |
| Metalworking           | 1300            | 3.3 | 6.8           |

Rappaport, T. Wireless Communications: Principles & Practice, Prentice Hall, Inc., 2002.



# Distance estimation

```
def estimate_distance(rssi):  
    p_tx = -66  
    c = 2  
    return math.sqrt(c*p_tx/rssi)
```

# Position estimation

$$\begin{array}{rcccl} & a & b & c & \\ \underbrace{\hspace{1.5cm}} & & \underbrace{\hspace{1.5cm}} & \underbrace{\hspace{4cm}} & \\ 2(x_3 - x_1)x_u + 2(y_3 - y_1)y_u & = & (r_1^2 - r_3^2) - (x_1^2 - x_3^2) - (y_1^2 - y_3^2) & & \\ \underbrace{\hspace{1.5cm}} & & \underbrace{\hspace{1.5cm}} & \underbrace{\hspace{4cm}} & \\ 2(x_3 - x_2)x_u + 2(y_3 - y_2)y_u & = & (r_2^2 - r_3^2) - (x_2^2 - x_3^2) - (y_2^2 - y_3^2) & & \\ d & & e & f & \end{array}$$

$$ax_u + by_u = c$$

$$dx_u + ey_u = f$$

$$x_u = \frac{ce - bf}{ae - bd} \quad y_u = \frac{af - cd}{ae - bd}$$

# Position estimation

```
def estimate_position():  
    a = 2 * (beacons["beacon_3"]["x"] - beacons["beacon_1"]["x"])  
    b = 2 * (beacons["beacon_3"]["y"] - beacons["beacon_1"]["y"])  
    c = beacons["beacon_1"]["r"] ** 2 - beacons["beacon_3"]["r"] ** 2 - beacons["beacon_1"]["x"] ** 2 + \\\n        beacons["beacon_3"]["x"] ** 2 - beacons["beacon_1"]["y"] ** 2 + beacons["beacon_3"]["y"] ** 2  
    d = 2 * (beacons["beacon_3"]["x"] - beacons["beacon_2"]["x"])  
    e = 2 * (beacons["beacon_3"]["y"] - beacons["beacon_2"]["y"])  
    f = beacons["beacon_2"]["r"] ** 2 - beacons["beacon_3"]["r"] ** 2 - beacons["beacon_2"]["x"] ** 2 + \\\n        beacons["beacon_3"]["x"] ** 2 - beacons["beacon_2"]["y"] ** 2 + beacons["beacon_3"]["y"] ** 2  
    x = (c * e - b * f) / (a * e - b * d)  
    y = (a * f - c * d) / (a * e - b * d)  
    return x, y
```

# **ACTIVITY RECOGNITION**

# Problem

Given a location, a set of sensor readings, and a person,  
recognise the physical activity the person is performing in the  
location

# Activity recognition

- Types of sensors
  - Vision sensors
  - Wearable sensors
  - Simple sensors
- Types of techniques
  - Based on machine learning
  - Based on logical reasoning
- Types of environments
  - Elderly care homes
  - Households
  - Offices
  - ...

# Closer look

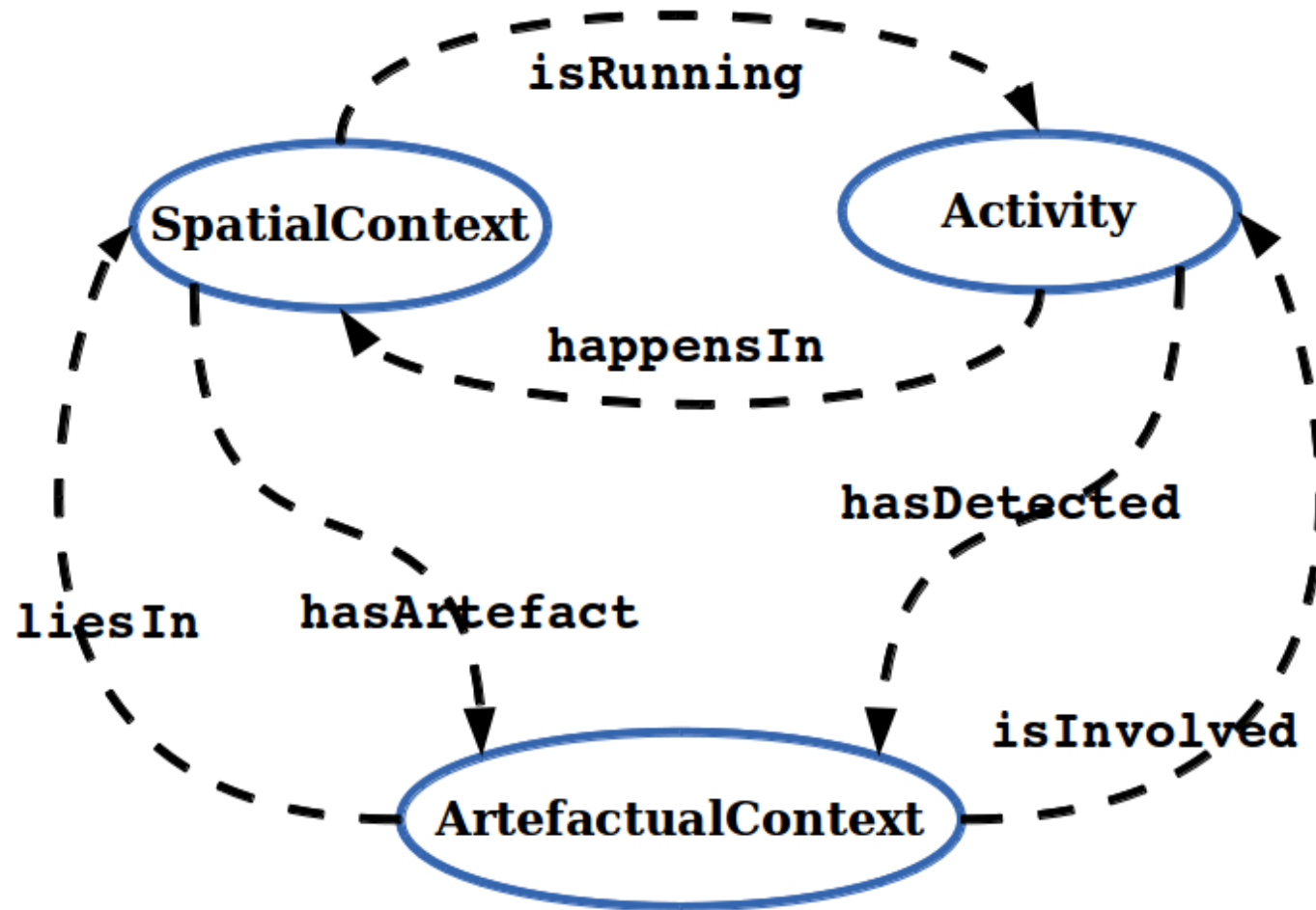
- Simple sensors
- Ontological reasoning
- Office building

# Office activities

| Office AA    | Performed activities  | Definition                                                                | Involved artefacts                           |
|--------------|-----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| WorkingRoom  | Working with PC       | User is using PC, PC and monitor are turn on                              | Chair, PC, and monitor                       |
|              | Working without PC    | User is sitting at the desk but PC and monitor are turned off             | Chair                                        |
|              | Presence              | User is active in the room but no further specific activity is recognized | Movement detector                            |
|              | Absence               | User is absent from the room                                              | No artefacts involved                        |
| MeetingRoom  | Giving a presentation | User is giving a presentation with the projector                          | Chairs, Projector, human voice detector      |
|              | Having a meeting      | Users are discussing at the meeting table                                 | Chairs, human voice detector                 |
|              | Presence              | User is active in the room but the specific activity is not recognized    | Movement detector                            |
|              | Absence               | User is absent from the room                                              | No artefacts involved                        |
| CoffeeCorner | Having a coffee break | Users are having lunch/coffee or just a break                             | Coffee machine, microwave, movement detector |
|              | Absence               | There is no one at the CoffeeCorner                                       | No artefacts involved                        |



# Overview of ontologies



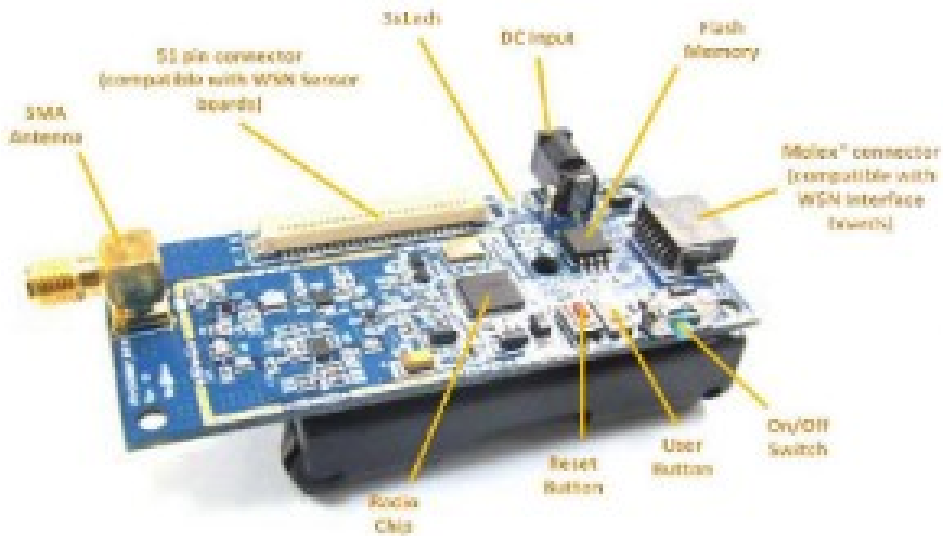
# Algorithm

- Get the current readings of all relevant sensors
- Convert sensor readings to corresponding properties in the ontologies
- Aggregate and fuse sensor readings using ontologies
- Reason over ontologies to recognise activities performed in all activity areas at the current time
- Return the result of reasoning as a list of activities with corresponding areas

# Implementation

- Sensors
  - Passive infrared sensor
  - Pressure sensor
  - Microphone
  - Electricity measuring plug
- Ontologies
  - [OWL2 Web Ontology Language](#)
  - [Protégé](#)
- Ontological reasoner
  - [HermiT](#)
- Algorithm

# Sensors



(a) Advantic TelosB mote



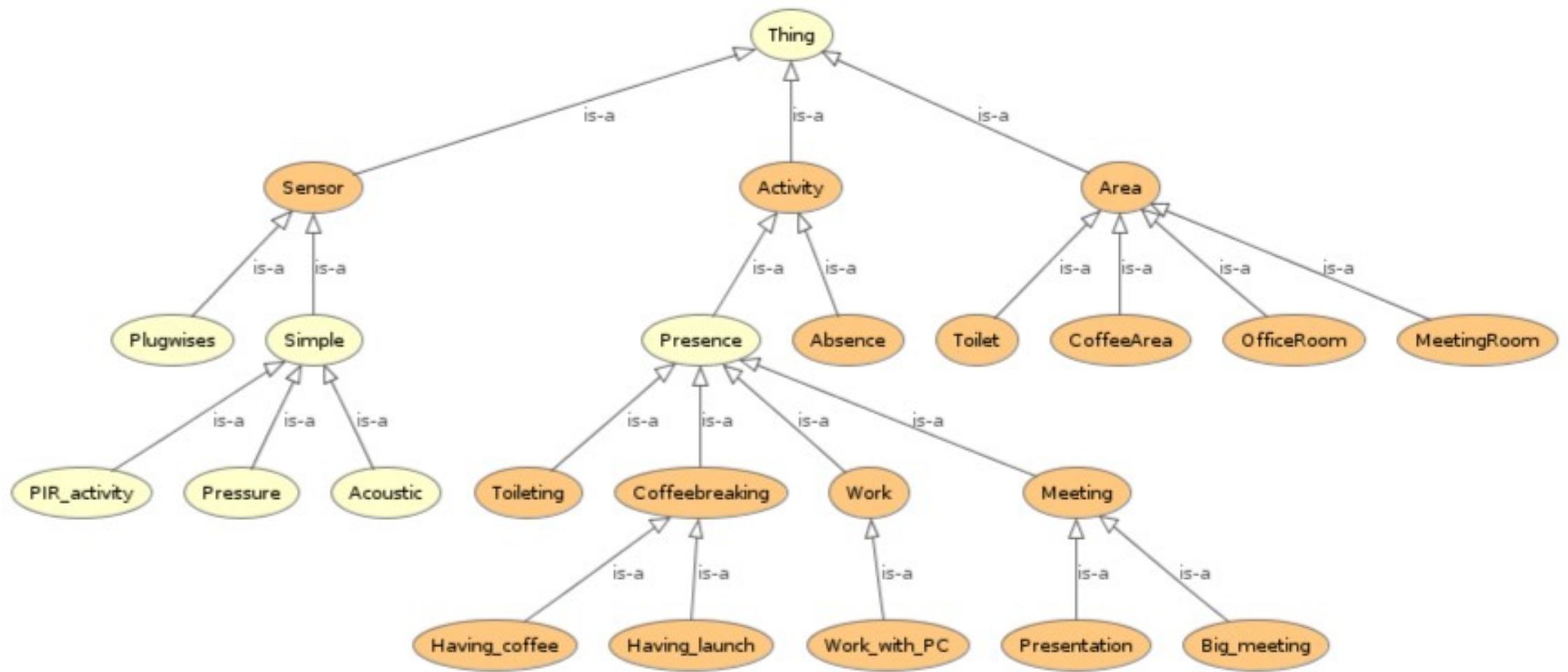
(b) Tekscan®  
A201-100  
pressure  
sensor



(c) PIR and Acoustic sensors



Fig. 8: Plugwise Cirle, Circle+, and Stick



# Ontologies in OWL2

- *#Area*
  - *#Area*  $\equiv \exists(\text{#isRunning.}\text{#Activity})$
  - *#Area*  $\sqsubseteq (\text{#MeetingRoom} \sqcup \text{#OfficeRoom} \sqcup \text{#CoffeeCorner})$
  - Subclasses
    - *#CoffeeCorner*  $\sqsubseteq \text{#Area}$
    - *#CoffeeCorner*  $\equiv \text{#isRunning.}(\text{#Absence} \sqcup \text{#CoffeeBreak})$

# Ontologies in OWL2

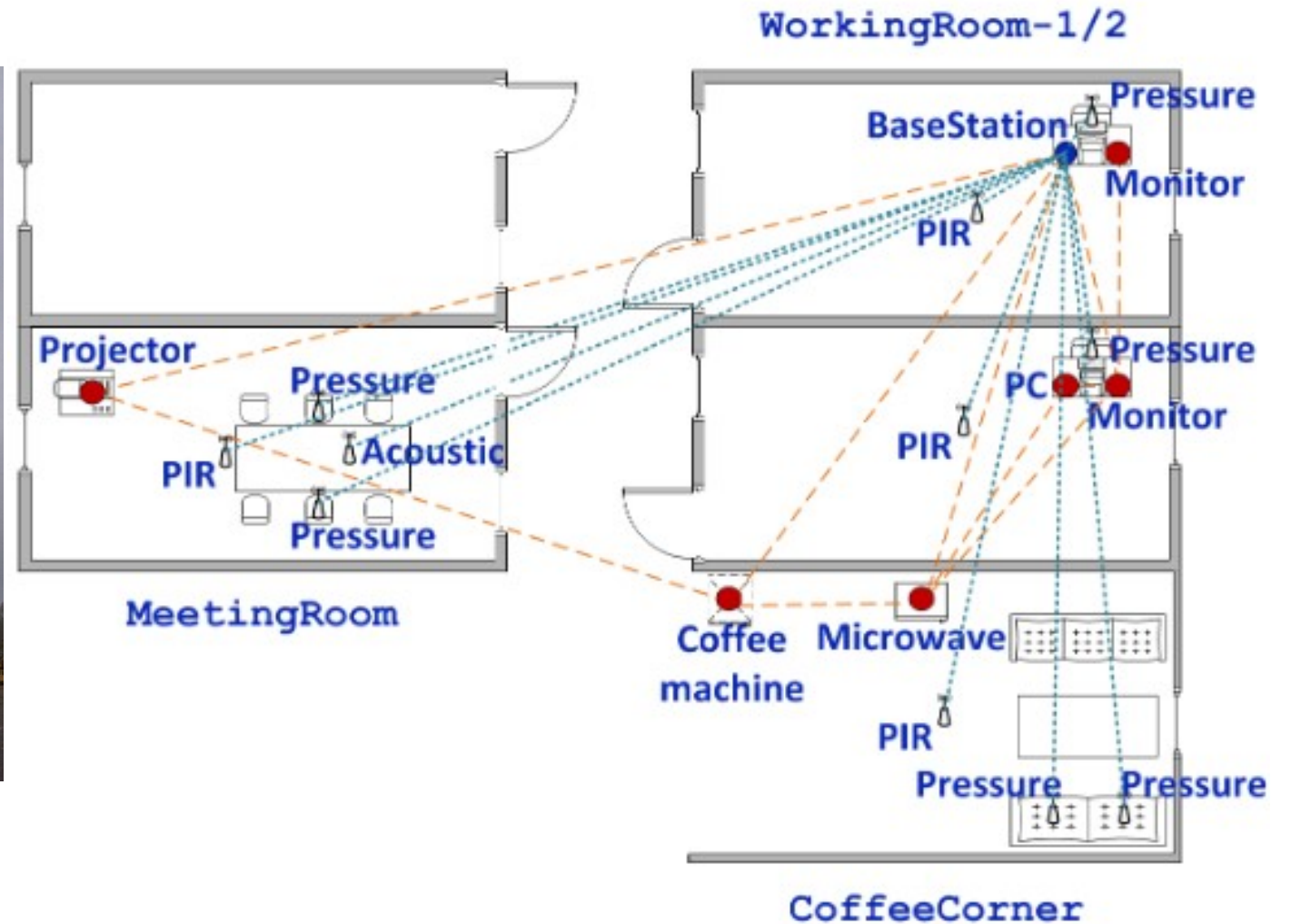
- *#Sensor*
  - $\#Sensor \sqsubseteq (\#Plugwises \sqcup \#Simple)$
  - $\#Sensor \equiv (\exists \#liesIn. \#Area) \sqcap (\#hasID: nonNegativeInteger)$
  - Subclasses (see reference [4])
  - Sensor instances as individuals
    - $\#CoffeeConer_{Acoustic} \in \#Acoustic \sqcap (\#liesIn. \#CoffeeCorner)$
    - $\#CoffeeCorner_{PIR} \in \#PIR \sqcap (\#liesIn. \#CoffeeCorner)$
    - $\#CoffeeCorner_{Microwave} \in \#Plugwise \sqcap (\#liesIn. \#CoffeeCorner)$

# Ontologies in OWL2

- *#Activity*
  - *#Activity*  $\sqsubseteq$  (*#Absence*  $\sqcup$  *#Presence*)
  - *#Activity*  $\equiv \exists(\textit{\#hasDetected}.\textit{\#Sensor})$
  - Subclasses
    - *#CoffeeBreak*  $\sqsubseteq$  *#Activity*
    - *#CoffeeBreak*  $\equiv \exists\textit{\#hasDetected}.\textit{(\#liesIn: \#CoffeeCorner)}$



# Experimental setup



# Ground truth

**Table 7.8:** Ground truth of the occurrences of activity instance at each activity area

| Area          | Activity |      |     |      |      |      |       |
|---------------|----------|------|-----|------|------|------|-------|
|               | Wpc      | W    | P   | M    | C    | B    | A     |
| WorkingRoom-1 | 3600     | 2700 | 0   | 0    | 0    | 1800 | 9900  |
| WorkingRoom-2 | 4500     | 2700 | 0   | 0    | 0    | 900  | 9900  |
| MeetingRoom   | 0        | 0    | 900 | 3600 | 0    | 0    | 13500 |
| CoffeeCorner  | 0        | 0    | 0   | 0    | 2700 | 0    | 15300 |

A = Absence; B = Being present; W = Working without PC; Wpc = Working with PC; M = Having a meeting; P = Giving a presentation; C = Coffee break

# Results

**Table 7.9: Success rates of the system at each area**

| Area                              | $\sum_{\text{activities}} FN$ | Success rate |
|-----------------------------------|-------------------------------|--------------|
| WorkingRoom-1                     | 1429                          | 92.06%       |
| WorkingRoom-2                     | 1403                          | 92.21%       |
| MeetingRoom                       | 939                           | 94.78%       |
| CoffeeCorner                      | 463                           | 97.43%       |
| $T_{all} = 18000 \text{ seconds}$ |                               |              |

**Table 7.10: Results for working room 1**

|                      |               |             |             |             |
|----------------------|---------------|-------------|-------------|-------------|
| (a) Confusion matrix |               |             |             |             |
| Recognised as →      | Wpc           | W           | B           | A           |
| Working with PC      | <b>3349</b>   | 251         | 0           | 0           |
| Working without PC   | 163           | <b>2474</b> | 33          | 30          |
| Being present        | 60            | 187         | <b>1511</b> | 42          |
| Absence              | 149           | 30          | 484         | <b>9237</b> |
| (b) Precision/Recall |               |             |             |             |
| Activity             | Precision (%) |             | Recall(%)   |             |
| Working with PC      | 90.00         |             | 93.03       |             |
| Working without PC   | 84.09         |             | 91.63       |             |
| Being present        | 74.51         |             | 83.94       |             |
| Absence              | 99.23         |             | 93.30       |             |

A = Absence; B = Being present; W = Working without PC; Wpc = Working with PC

# Final remarks

- At the University of Stuttgart, we have experts in AI planning, automated service composition, and smart energy systems, should you be interested in doing a research project, thesis, or PhD.
- We offer both theoretical and application-oriented research projects, although availability may vary based on current capacity.
- I hope you enjoyed the course. Good luck with the project demo and exam.

Thank you for taking the course

# References

1. Poslad, S., Ubiquitous Computing: Smart Devices, Environments and Interactions, John Wiley & Sons Ltd., 2009.
2. Perera, C., Zaslavsky, A., Christen, P., Georgakopoulos, D., Context Aware Computing for The Internet of Things: A Survey, IEEE Communications Surveys & Tutorials, 16(1): 414-454, IEEE, 2014.
3. Schmidt, A. Ubiquitous Computing – Computing in Context, PhD thesis, Lancaster University, 2002.
4. Nguyen, T.A., Energy Adaptive Buildings: From sensor data to being aware of users, PhD thesis, University of Groningen, 2015.
5. Aggarwal, J. K. and Ryoo, M. S. 2011. Human activity analysis: A review. ACM Comput. Surv. 43, 3, Article 16.

